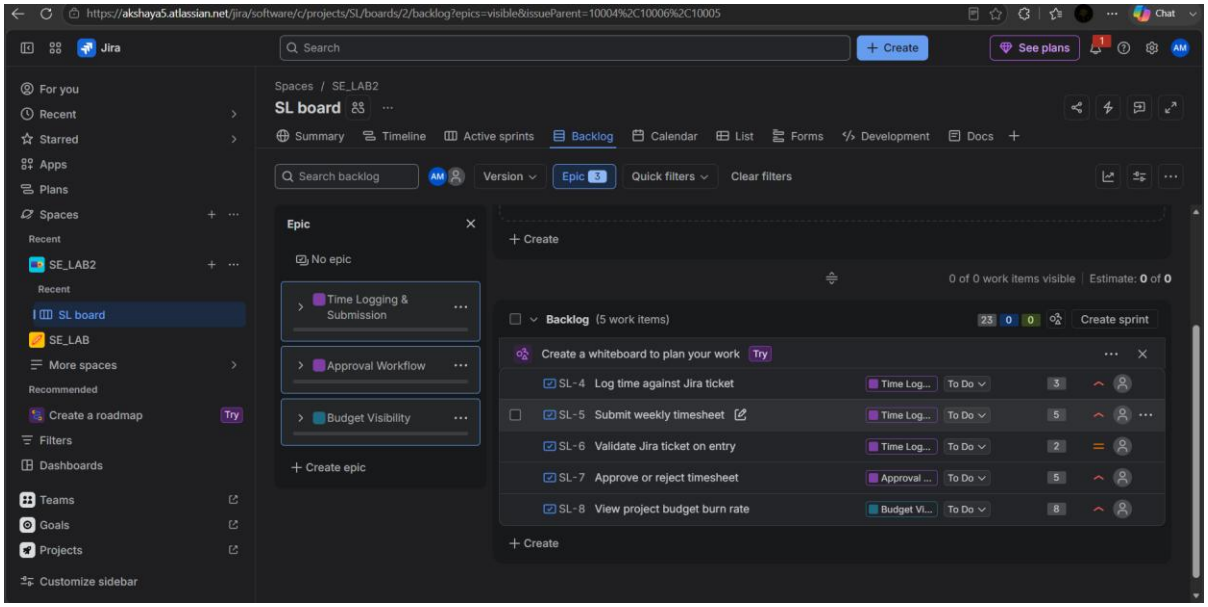
Software Engineering

Lab 2: Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

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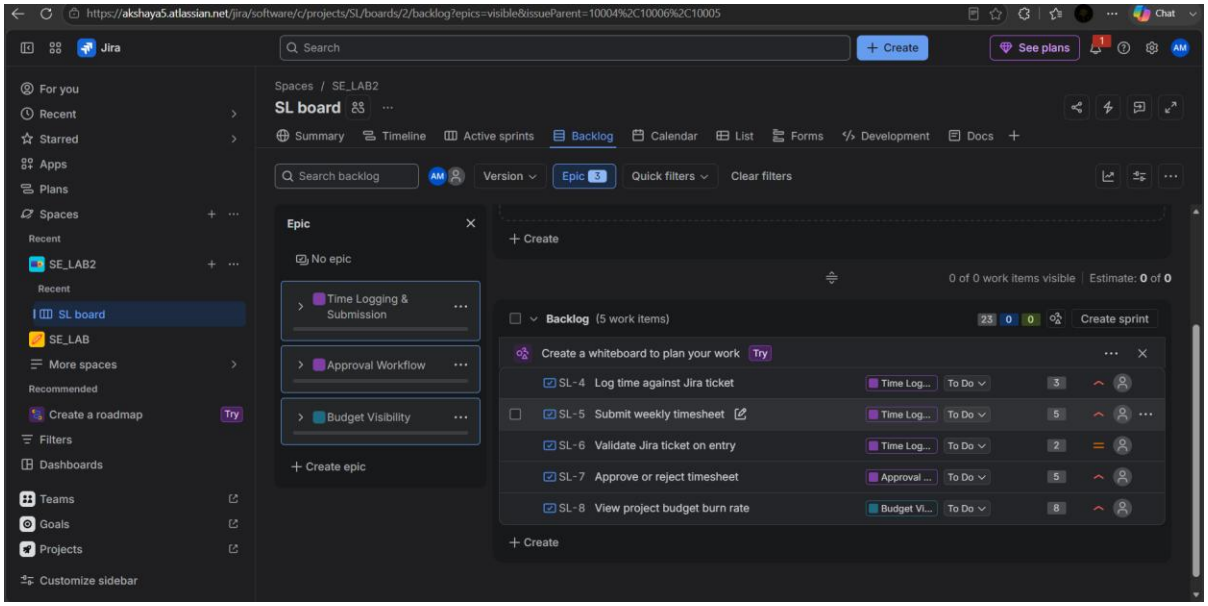
Problem Statement - Remote Team Time-Tracking & Project Approver

Screenshot 1: Jira Backlog with Epics and User Stories



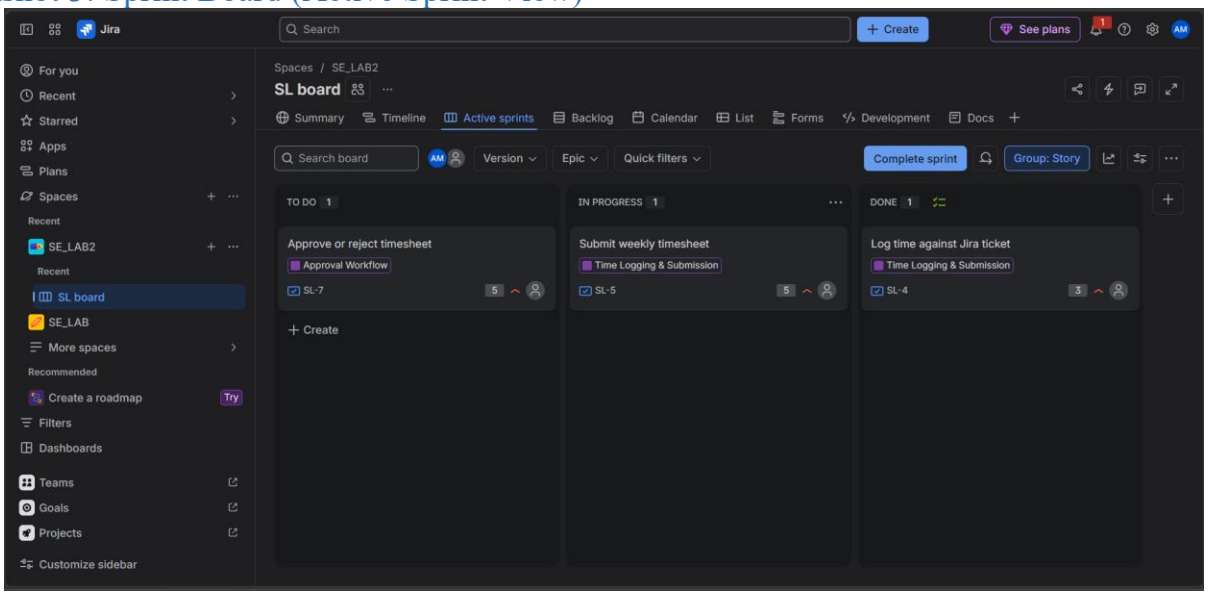
Backlog view showing 3 Epics (Time Logging & Submission, Approval Workflow, Budget Visibility) and 5 User Stories.

Screenshot 2: Story Point Assignments



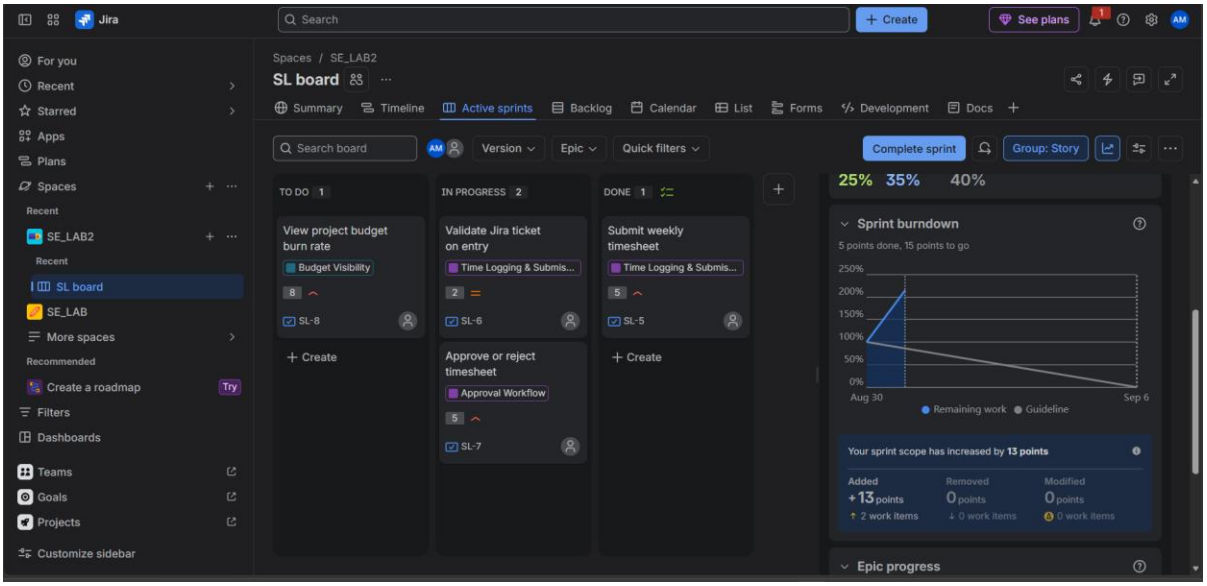
Story points assigned per Fibonacci scale (3, 5, 2, 5, 8) across all 5 stories, total 23 points.

Screenshot 3: Sprint Board (Active Sprint View)



Active sprint board mid-simulation showing stories distributed across To Do, In Progress, and Done.

Screenshot 4: Burndown Chart



Sprint burndown chart showing 5 points done, 15 points remaining, with a mid-sprint scope increase of 13 points.

Reflection Questions

1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Mostly yes for the simpler stories. Log Time Against Jira Ticket (3 points) and Validate Jira Ticket on Entry (2 points) were estimated low and stayed straightforward to move through the board, which matched expectations. The higher estimates were less predictable: View Project Budget Burn Rate was given 8 points as the most complex story in the backlog, and it was the one item still sitting in To Do by the end of the second sprint, so the estimate correctly flagged it as the riskiest item even though it did not get completed in the simulated timeframe.

2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

The priority levels carried over consistently from the Lab 1 requirements table: four of the five stories were marked High priority (logging time, submitting timesheets, approving or rejecting timesheets, and viewing the budget burn rate) since they represent the core workflow, while Validate Jira Ticket on Entry was Medium since it is a supporting validation rather than a primary user-facing action. In hindsight, splitting the Budget Visibility epic into a smaller first version and a later enhanced version might have made it easier to finish within a single sprint instead of it becoming the constant carry-over item.

3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

Sprint 1 planned three stories (Log Time, Submit Timesheet, Approve or Reject Timesheet) but only one (Log Time) reached Done before the sprint was closed, with Submit Timesheet still In Progress and Approve or Reject Timesheet still in To Do. Those two incomplete items rolled into Sprint 2 along with the remaining backlog items, and the sprint scope for Sprint 2 grew by 13 points once they were added. Sprint 2 completed one more story (Submit Weekly Timesheet), leaving Validate Jira Ticket, Approve or Reject Timesheet, and View Project Budget Burn Rate open at the end of the simulation. The plan was reasonably sound, but the simulated capacity per sprint turned out to be lower than the total points committed.

4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The Sprint 2 burndown chart showed 5 points done against 15 points remaining, with the remaining-work line staying well above the ideal guideline line for most of the sprint before a late drop. This pattern, combined with the scope increase of 13 points partway through, suggests the simulated sprints were consistently over-committed relative to what could realistically be closed out in a one-week window. For a real team, this would be a signal to either shorten the sprint scope or break down the larger stories (like the 8-point Budget Burn Rate story) into smaller pieces so progress stays closer to the guideline line.